

Your mission:

You work for Parks Victoria as a **Park Ranger** in the Toolangi State Forest. You are monitoring where Leadbeater's possums live in your forest. You will use this information to report on where they live and to suggest ways to help them to survive.

You have set up a **fair test to compare two forest areas: Forest Site 1 and Forest Site 2**. A colony of Leadbeater's possums was seen living at each site one year ago.

Testable Question: Does a change in the forest understory affect the number of Leadbeater's possums in the forest?

Reasoned Prediction: When there is a thick forest understory the number of Leadbeater's possums will increase.

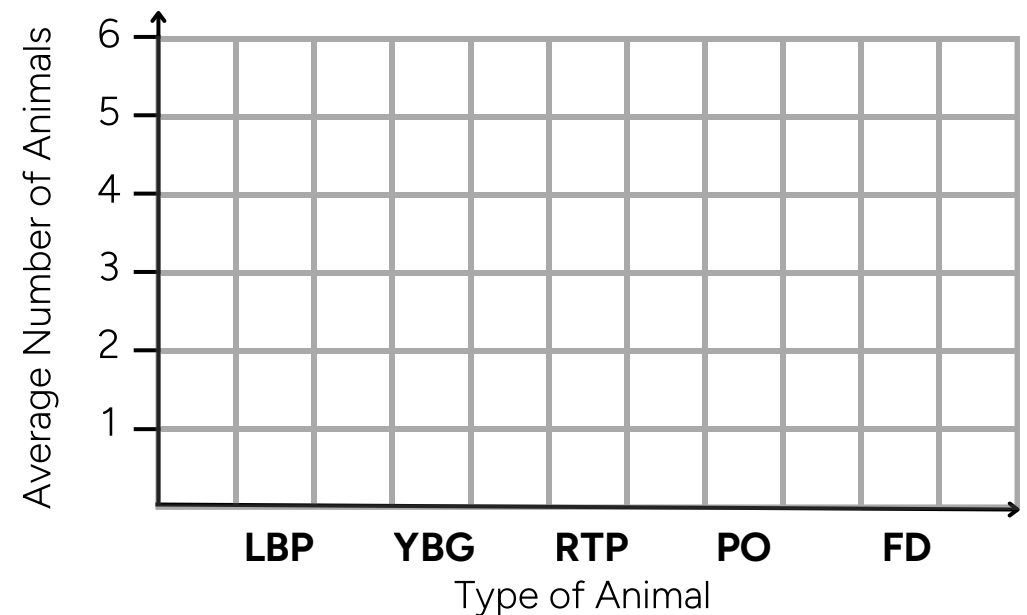
First you surveyed site 1. An image of site 1 is shown below. The data your team collected is shown in table 1. Use this data to draw a **bar graph** to view the numbers of animals found at site 1.



Table 1: Data collected for 5 animals surveyed at forest Site 1

SITE 1	Night 1	Night 2	Night 3	Average
Leadbeater's Possum (LBP)	5	7	6	6
Yellow Bellied Glider (YBG)	2	4	3	3
Ring-tailed Possum (RTP)	3	6	3	4
Powerful Owl (PO)	1	1	1	1
Feral Deer (FD)	0	0	0	0

Title: Average number of 5 surveyed animals at forest Site 1



Possum-ly the best scientist in the lab!

You have set up a **fair test to compare two forest areas: Forset Site 1 and Forest Site 2**. First you surveyed site 1. Now you have surveyed site 2.



An image of forest site 2 is shown on the left. **List five differences** you can see **when you compare** forest site 1 with forest site 2:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

The data your team collected at forest site 2 is shown in table 2. Use this data to draw a bar graph to view the numbers of animals found at site 2.

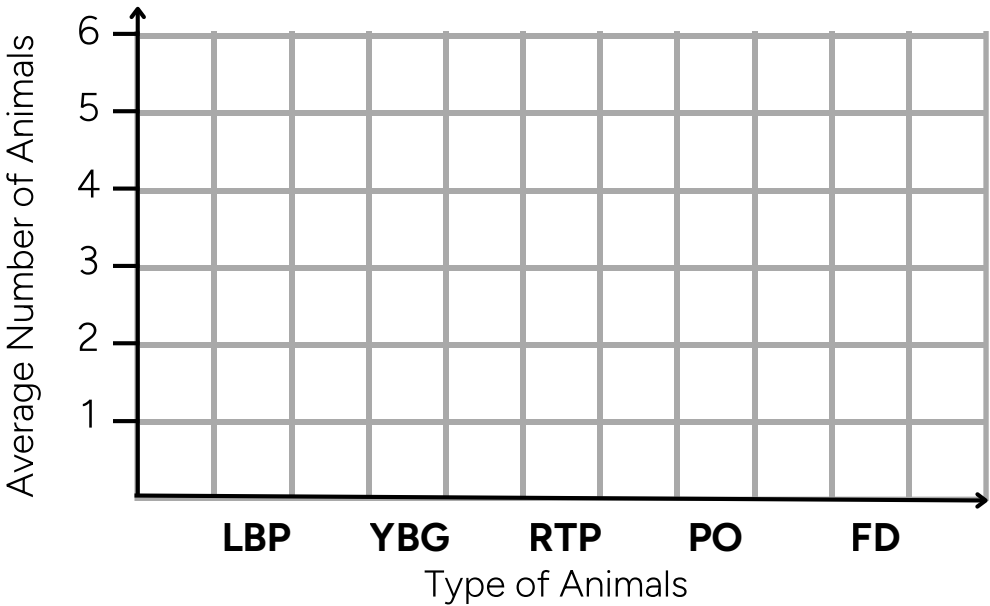
Table 2: Data collected for 5 animals surveyed at forest Site 2

SITE 2	Night 1	Night 2	Night 3	Average
Leadbeater’s Possum (LBP)	1	0	2	1
Yellow Bellied Glider (YBG)	1	0	2	1
Ring-tailed Possum (RTP)	3	5	4	4
Powerful Owl (PO)	1	1	1	1
Feral Deer (FD)	3	3	3	3

We use the forest understory to feed and to move between our nests in large trees



Title: Average number of 5 surveyed animals at forest Site 2



Your Task:
To make it easier to compare the data from forest site 1 and forest site 2 you will **combine both sets of data onto one bar graph**. This has been done for Leadbeater’s possum. Use this as a guide to draw bars for the remaining 4 animals surveyed. **Use the key** to tell Site 1 and Site 2 apart.

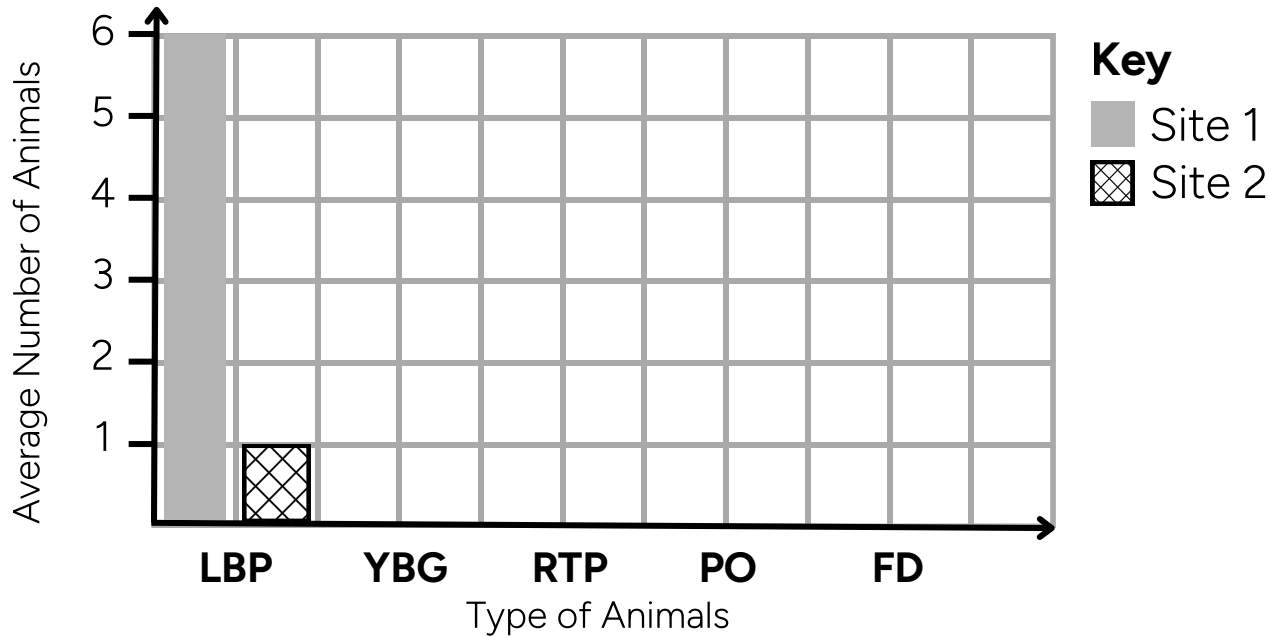
Testable Question: Does a change in the forest understory affect the number of Leadbeater’s possums in the forest?
Reasoned Prediction: When there is a thick forest understory the number of Leadbeater’s possums will increase.

Table 3: Averages of data collected for 5 animals surveyed at forest Site 1 and forest Site 2.

Type of Animal	Site 1	Site 2
Leadbeater’s Possum (LBP)	6	1
Yellow Bellied Glider (YBG)	3	1
Ring-tailed Possum (RTP)	4	4
Powerful Owl (PO)	1	1
Feral Deer (FD)	0	3



Title: Comparison of Number of Nocturnal Animals between Site 1 and Site 2



Compare the results for Site 1 and Site 2. Do the results support or not support the reasoned prediction?

Supported / Not supported

Give a reason for your answer using the data and forest pictures:

Brainstorm ideas: What can we do to help protect Leadbeater’s possums?